

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Warner Bros. Discovery** is splitting itself into two stand-alone publicly traded companies, separating its HBO Max streaming service, movie studio and TV production business from its cable networks. **A1**
- ◆ **Companies with no previous crypto ties** are investing in bitcoin, courting what some observers say is potential disaster should the token's price fall and taint the buyer's stock. **A1**
- ◆ **The FTC is asking** some of the world's largest ad companies for information as part of an investigation into whether advertising and advocacy groups violated anti-trust laws by coordinating boycotts of certain sites, including Elon Musk's X. **B1**
- ◆ **A rally in chip stocks** helped lift the S&P 500 and Nasdaq by 0.1% and 0.3%, respectively, while the Dow was little changed. **B11**
- ◆ **Ken Moelis, the dealmaker** who got his start with Michael Milken and launched his own investment bank in 2007, plans to resign as chief executive of Moelis & Co. **B1**
- ◆ **WPP Chief Executive** Mark Read will step down at year-end, triggering a search for a successor at the company after a string of advertiser client defections. **B2**
- ◆ **A judge dismissed** lawsuits brought by actor and director Justin Baldoni against actress Blake Lively, her husband, Ryan Reynolds, and the New York Times. **B1**
- ◆ **Alon, Oren and Tal Alexander** filed a defamation lawsuit against the publisher of The Real Deal. **B4**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Marines were deploying** to the Los Angeles area to protect federal buildings and workers after protests over immigration turned violent, stepping up the response as California officials blamed the Trump administration for raising tensions. **A1, A4, A6**
 - ◆ **Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.** removed all the members of a key committee that recommends vaccines, and how often adults and children should get them. **A3**
 - ◆ **The Social Security** commissioner said Elon Musk's Department of Government Efficiency is central to his plans for the agency, even though Musk is no longer in Trump's orbit. **A3**
 - ◆ **Democrats launched** a multimillion-dollar effort to turn Texas into a competitive political arena after decades of electoral losses in the second-largest U.S. state. **A3**
 - ◆ **Canada plans to boost** military spending this year, aiming to catch up to its NATO commitments and try to placate Trump amid sensitive trade talks. **A7**
 - ◆ **Israeli forces and allied** local gunmen fired toward a crowd heading to a food-distribution center in Gaza, Palestinians said, adding that 14 people were killed. **A7**
 - ◆ **A Chinese aircraft carrier** conducted drills hundreds of miles south of Japan's main island, venturing into waters that could be strategically vital in a conflict with the U.S. **A16**
 - ◆ **Died: Sly Stone, 82,** funk music icon and dynamic showman. **A2** ... **Frederick Forsyth, 86,** author of "The Day of the Jackal" and other thrillers. **A16**
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Members of the California National Guard were deployed in downtown Los Angeles on Monday amid new protests.

Marines Sent Into Los Angeles As Blame Traded Over Clashes

California leaders accuse Trump of incitement, file suit to stop Guard order

By Nancy A. Youssef, Mariah Timms and Paul Kiernan

LOS ANGELES—About 700 Marines were deploying Monday to the Los Angeles area to protect federal buildings and

fornia officials filed a lawsuit to stop the Trump administration's mobilization of the National Guard. The Marines, which are assigned to the 2nd Battalion, 7th Marines, 1st Marine Division out of Twentynine Palms, Calif., won't engage with protesters, U.S. Northern Command, which is responsible for military operations in North America, said in a statement. Their deployment follows President Trump's decision this weekend to send in National Guard troops to quell the protests. The unusual decision marks the first time in more than

three decades that Marines have been sent into a U.S. city to address civil unrest. It came over the objections of California Gov. Gavin Newsom, who has called the federal intervention an intrusion on state sovereignty. "They shouldn't be deployed on American soil facing their own countrymen to fulfill the deranged fantasy of a dictatorial President," Newsom, a Democrat, wrote in a post on X. Besides the National Guard lawsuit, Newsom said Monday he would also file a lawsuit seeking to prevent the Marines from being deployed. Trump, a Republican, wrote

in a social-media post that Newsom and Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass, a Democrat, should be grateful, and that Los Angeles "would have been completely obliterated" without the National Guard. The lawsuit filed by California officials in federal court in San Francisco asks a judge to set aside Trump's order calling in the National Guard. *Please turn to page A4*

- ◆ **Images help Trump pivot to issue he wants..... A4**
- ◆ **Protesters target Waymo driverless taxis..... A4**
- ◆ **Unions fight Trump's immigration plans..... A6**

ICE Ramped Up Migrant Raids After the White House Complained

After deportations fall short, agents told to 'go out there and arrest illegal aliens'

Even with the high-profile arrests of suspects by masked immigration agents and the plane loads of migrants swiftly ferried out of the U.S., Presi-

By Elizabeth Findell, Ruth Simon, Michelle Hackman and Tarini Parti

dent Trump was falling short of the number of daily deportations carried out by the Biden administration in its final year. So in late May, Stephen Miller, a top

White House aide and the architect of the president's immigration agenda, addressed a meeting at the headquarters of Immigration and Customs Enforcement, known as ICE. The message was clear: The president, who promised to deport millions of immigrants living in the country illegally, wasn't pleased. Agents had better step it up. Gang members and violent criminals, what Trump called the "worst of the worst," weren't the sole target of deportations. Federal agents needed to "just go out there and arrest illegal

aliens," Miller told top ICE officials, who had come from across the U.S., according to people familiar with the meeting. Agents didn't need to develop target lists of immigrants suspected of being in the U.S. illegally, a longstanding practice, Miller said. Instead, he directed them to target Home Depot, where day laborers typically gather for hire, or 7-Eleven convenience stores. Miller bet that he and a handful of agents could go out on the streets of *Please turn to page A6*

They Travel the World In Search of License Plates

Collectors cross the globe for rare finds, from diplomatic tags to the devilish 666

By ROBERT P. WALZER

Some people dream of scaling a peak or writing a novel. Ethan Craft wants to collect at least one license plate from 500 global jurisdictions. The quest has taken the 27-year-old across the world in search of junkyards, antique stores and other collectors willing to trade plates. It also nearly killed him. The Phoenix native and freelance journalist was recently driving through South Africa's rural Eastern Cape in a rickety Renault Kwid hatchback when he swerved to avoid debris, slammed into a rock wall and flipped over. Craft avoided major injury. As important, he was able to recover the dozens of plates that spilled onto the road—along with the tag on his rental car.

"I'm going to save that one for my will," said Craft. Stamp collectors are called philatelists. People who save coins are numismatists. License plate collecting is so arcane that there isn't a word for it. But there are thousands of people who so covet tags that they are willing to travel to remote corners of the globe—sometimes at great expense and personal risk—to score a rare find. Some collectors focus on geographic regions. Others target tags based on design or color. Numbers are big draws, too, namely low ones, birth dates, the devilish 666 and the code for marijuana, 420. Some seek out diplomatic tags or presidential inaugural ones. Others pursue early porcelain plates or those from countries at war. Tags from Vatican City are *Please turn to page A10*

INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Can you beat the high-schoolers in this personal-finance challenge? **A9**



SPORTS
The game-wrecking play that will decide the NBA championship. **A12**

Companies Binge On Crypto, Raising Returns and Risk

By VICKY GE HUANG

Buying bitcoin is becoming a fad for a growing list of companies that have nothing to do with crypto but believe digital assets can boost their stocks. The problem, some industry insiders said: This could expose crypto to new risks, amplifying selloffs in moments of turbulence. The approach has been pioneered by executives such as bitcoin evangelist Michael Saylor, who has turned his software company Strategy into a warehouse for the digital currency. Other companies are following suit. About 60 companies with no previous ties to the market are now pursuing the "bitcoin-treasury strategy," according to Standard Chartered Bank, citing data from BitcoinTreasuries.net. They make software, and offer marketing and

Warner Discovery Planning Spinoff Of Cable

Entertainment giant is contending with a hefty debt load and sagging stock price

By JOE FLINT

Warner Bros. Discovery is splitting itself into two stand-alone publicly traded entertainment companies, separating its HBO Max streaming service, movie studio and television-production business from its cable networks. One company will be home to CNN, TNT, TBS and Warner's dozens of cable channels, as well as its international holdings. That entity, called Global Networks for now, will hold as much as a 20% stake in the second entity, which Warner is referring to as Streaming & Studios. It plans to use earnings from that stake to pay off debt. The move effectively undoes much of Warner Media and Discovery Communications' 2022 merger, separating Warner's marquee film and TV from Discovery's reality and nonfiction fare. Warner, like other entertainment companies including Disney and Paramount Global, has seen ratings and revenue decline in its once-powerful cable network operation, with consumers ditching traditional pay-television in favor of streaming. Comcast is in the process of spinning off the bulk of its cable-network business into a stand-alone company *Please turn to page A8*

China Exports To U.S. Sink

Chinese shipments to the U.S. in May fell by their biggest percentage decline since the Covid shutdown. **A2**

